

Spanish A1 — Week 12 Student Overview

Crescere | Beginner Spanish | Week 12

Theme: Final Performance and Course Close

What Week 12 Is For

Week 12 is not a test.

It is an opportunity to show what you can do in Spanish after twelve weeks of study. The final performance is a demonstration — a real conversation and a short written message that prove you have reached A1 level. You will not be graded on whether every word is perfect. You will be assessed on whether you can communicate.

You have already done harder things in this course. If you navigated a doctor's appointment in Spanish last week, you can do this.

What the Final Performance Involves

Part A — Spoken Role Play (5–7 minutes)

You will have a conversation in Spanish with your instructor. The setting is informal — you have just met someone, or you are helping someone navigate a situation.

Your conversation will move through some or all of these areas:

- Introduce yourself: who you are, where you are from, what you do — using *ser* and *estar*
- Make a plan: suggest something to do together, agree on a time and place (*ir a + infinitivo*)
- Give directions: help the other person get somewhere in the city
- Describe a place: your home, your neighbourhood, something about where you live

You do not need to memorize a script. Practice the topics. Know your vocabulary. Then speak.

Part B — Written Message (8–10 sentences)

You will write a short message to a Spanish-speaking contact — someone you have just met who wants to know more about you.

Your message must include:

- An introduction (using *ser*: who you are, where you are from, what you do)
- Something about how you feel or where you are right now (using *estar*)
- A description of your daily routine (at least 2 sentences)
- Something you enjoy doing (*gustar, encantar, or preferir*)
- A suggestion to meet or do something together
- At least one question for the other person

You may use the Week 12 phrase bank during Part B. You may not read a prepared script for Part A.

The Most Important Structure This Week: Ser and Estar

Spanish A1 has been built around one foundational distinction: **ser vs. estar**. You use both in real life constantly. The final performance will give you a chance to show you have understood the difference.

Quick reminder:

Use	Verb	Example
Identity, origin, profession, permanent description	<i>ser</i>	<i>Soy inglés. Soy médico. Soy alto.</i>
State, emotion, condition, location	<i>estar</i>	<i>Estoy cansado. Estoy en casa. La farmacia está cerca.</i>

If you are ever unsure: ask yourself "*Is this a permanent fact about who I am, or a temporary state of how things are right now?*"

How to Prepare

Between Session 23 and Session 24:

1. **Practice the role play topics out loud** — not in your head. Say your introduction, make your plan, give directions, describe your neighbourhood, out loud, alone. Three times minimum.
 2. **Draft your written message** — write it, read it aloud, check it. Is every *ser/estar* choice correct? Do *gustar/encantar* sentences use *gusta/gustan* correctly? Are contractions right (*al, del*)?
 3. **Skim the phrase bank** — the Week 12 phrase bank collects the most useful expressions from across Spanish A1. Spend 5–10 minutes with it the evening before Session 24 to remind yourself what is in it. You do not need to memorize it. During Part B (written message), you may have it open as a reference — it is a support tool, not a test of what you can recall.
 4. **Know your repair phrases cold:**
 - *¿Puede repetir, por favor?*
 - *¿Cómo se dice [word] en español?*
 - *No sé cómo decirlo — intento decirlo de otra manera.*
 5. **Sleep.** Rest is more useful the night before than another hour of study.
-

What Counts as Success at A1

You have demonstrated A1 competency when you can:

- ☐ Introduce yourself (using *ser* and *estar*) without preparation in 4–5 sentences
- ☐ Ask and answer basic questions about your life, work, and interests
- ☐ Make plans with someone — suggest an activity, agree on a time and place
- ☐ Give and follow basic directions in a city
- ☐ Order food or ask for help in a practical situation
- ☐ Use *ir a + infinitivo* for future plans
- ☐ Use *gustar/doler* with correct agreement
- ☐ Write a personal message of 8+ sentences that is clear and mostly correct

This is a significant achievement. Spanish presents challenges English speakers rarely encounter in other languages — two verbs for "to be," verbs where the subject is an indirect object (*gustar*, *doler*), stem-changing verbs, reflexive pronouns. You have navigated all of this. That matters.

Mistakes Are Expected

No A1 student produces perfect Spanish. Mistakes at this level are normal, expected, and not penalized.

What the instructor is looking for:

- Can you get your meaning across?
- Do you keep going when you get stuck?
- Do you recover from mistakes rather than shutting down?
- Do you use a range of the Spanish you have learned?

A student who tries a complex sentence and makes a small grammar error is doing something more impressive than a student who only uses the safest patterns. Ambition is rewarded.

If you don't know a word, say: "*¿Cómo se dice...?*" and keep going. That is exactly what fluent speakers do.

Example: What Part A Might Look Like

Instructor (as Spanish stranger): ¡Hola! ¿Eres de aquí?

Student: Hola! No — soy americano/a, de Nueva York. Pero vivo aquí desde hace dos años. ¿Y tú?

Instructor: Soy español — Llegué el mes pasado. Todavía no conozco bien la ciudad.

Student: Puedo ayudarte. ¿Qué buscas?

Instructor: Busco una farmacia — me duele la cabeza desde esta mañana.

Student: Hay una farmacia muy cerca. Sigues todo recto hasta el semáforo, y giras a la izquierda. Está al lado del supermercado.

Instructor: Perfecto, gracias. ¿Y a ti qué te gusta hacer por aquí?

Student: Me encanta el mercado los domingos — y voy a ir este fin de semana. ¿Quieres venir?

Instructor: ¡Sí! ¿A qué hora quedamos?

This is six exchanges. It includes: introduction (*ser*), expressing a physical state (*me duele*), giving directions, making a plan (*ir a + infinitivo*), using *hay*, using *gustar/encantar*. No sentence is perfect. It is very good A1 Spanish.

What Comes After A1

When you complete Spanish A1, you are ready to begin Spanish A2.

What A2 adds:

- Talking about the past: *pretérito indefinido* — what you did (*fui, comí, estudié, hice*)
- The *imperfecto* — what things were like or what you used to do (*era, tenía, vivía*)
- The contrast between the two past tenses — one of the most important skills in A2
- Object pronouns: *te lo doy, me la das*

- Richer vocabulary for work, travel, and social situations

You are not starting from zero in A2. Every structure you have learned — ser/estar, regular verbs, irregular verbs, ir a + infinitivo, tener que, gustar, doler, reflexive verbs, prepositions — is reinforced and built upon in A2.

The single most useful thing you can do between A1 and A2: spend 5–10 minutes per day with Spanish. A news podcast in simple Spanish, a Spanish TV series with subtitles, one sentence per day in a journal. Keeping the language active between courses is what prevents the knowledge from fading.

Crescere — Spanish A1 Week 12 / Questions? Contact your instructor.